

DOC 2 — SOLUTIONS: Inference / Complete-the-Text (80 MCQs)

EASY (Q1-Q16)

Q1. Correct Answer: D

REASONING: The passage says synchronized flashing evolved to reduce "visual clutter" so signals are "easier to distinguish from those of other species flashing at different intervals." The benefit is about distinguishing one species from another. This benefit matters most when multiple species are present producing overlapping signals.

WHY EACH WRONG:

- A) Population decline from habitat loss is unrelated to the signal-clarity benefit described.
- B) Light pollution from humans is a different interference source, not the inter-species confusion the passage describes.
- C) Predator detection is not mentioned; the passage focuses on mating-signal clarity. **TRAP ALERT** ☹ B and C are plausible real-world threats to fireflies but are not supported by the passage's specific logic about distinguishing species from each other.

KEY INSIGHT ♀ The clue phrase is "easier to distinguish from those of OTHER SPECIES." The correct completion must involve the presence of other species.

FAST METHOD ⚡ Ask: what condition makes "reducing visual clutter among species" useful? Answer: multiple species coexisting.

Q2. Correct Answer: A

REASONING: The passage says GDP "does not account for" important factors and researchers "suggest" supplementing it. The word "supplemented" in B matches the passage's logic: GDP is useful but incomplete.

WHY EACH WRONG:

- B) "Replaced" and "exclusively" are too extreme; the passage says supplemented, not replaced.
- C) GDP was designed to measure economic output, not happiness — this reverses the passage.
- D) The passage criticizes GDP's scope, not its accuracy. **TRAP ALERT** ☹ A is tempting because it sounds reform-minded, but "replaced" and "exclusively" overstate the passage's measured suggestion.

KEY INSIGHT ♀ "Incomplete picture" = supplement, not replace.

FAST METHOD ⚡ The passage says GDP is useful but insufficient. Match the moderate tone.

Q3. Correct Answer: A

REASONING: Clay = Chinese origin; motifs = Persian style. "Manufactured in China" + "Persian-influenced designs" = made in China, decorated in a cross-cultural style before trade.

WHY EACH WRONG: - B) "No knowledge of Chinese techniques" contradicts the Chinese clay evidence. - C) The formula matched Chinese deposits, not Persian ones. - D) "Exclusively within China" contradicts the pottery being found at a Silk Road trading settlement.

KEY INSIGHT ♀ The passage provides two independent lines of evidence (clay chemistry + decorative style) pointing to two different regions, implying cross-cultural production.

FAST METHOD ⚡ Chinese clay + Persian motifs = made in China, styled with Persian influence.

Q4. Correct Answer: C

REASONING: The passage explains that neoteny persisted because the stable, resource-rich waters "offered little advantage for a shift to land." This frames neoteny as a response to specific environmental conditions — i.e., an adaptation.

WHY EACH WRONG:

- A) "Temporary" and "eventually outgrow" contradict "retains its larval features throughout adulthood."
- B) "All salamander species" is an overgeneralization not supported by the passage.
- D) The passage presents neoteny as an advantage in its environment, not a disadvantage. **TRAP ALERT** ☹ D is tempting because it sounds like a reasonable ecological concern, but the passage frames neoteny positively within its native habitat.

KEY INSIGHT ☹ "Little advantage for a shift to land" = the environment shaped the trait = adaptation.

FAST METHOD ✂ Environment shaped trait → adaptation.

Q5. Correct Answer: B

REASONING: The paintings were "nearly identical" and "differed only in their attributed authorship," yet participants rated the famous artist's work as more creative. This means reputation, not the artwork itself, drove the judgment.

WHY EACH WRONG: - A) Training is irrelevant; the issue is bias from reputation, not skill deficiency. - C) Style preferences are not tested — the paintings were identical. - D) "Guessed at random" would produce equal ratings, not systematic favoritism.

KEY INSIGHT ☹ Same paintings, different attributions, different ratings = reputation bias.

FAST METHOD ✂ Only variable = authorship attribution. That's what caused the difference.

Q6. Correct Answer: D

REASONING: Olivine weathers rapidly when exposed to water and CO₂. Oman is arid with "minimal rainfall." The survival of olivine on the surface in Oman implies that the lack of water slowed the weathering process.

WHY EACH WRONG:

- A) The passage says olivine is "abundant in Earth's upper mantle," and nothing suggests Oman's olivine formed on the surface.
- B) Different chemical composition is not mentioned or implied.
- C) "Equally common on the surfaces of all desert environments" is an unsupported overgeneralization. **KEY INSIGHT** ☹ Cause (water + CO₂) is absent → effect (weathering) is slowed.

FAST METHOD ✂ Olivine breaks down in water. Oman has little water. Olivine survives.

Q7. Correct Answer: C

REASONING: Haruki says "nothing here had changed but himself." The village seems smaller not because it physically shrank, but because he grew. His broader experience makes the village appear smaller by comparison.

WHY EACH WRONG:

- A) "Deteriorated" is contradicted by "nothing here had changed."
- B) "Deliberately reduced the width of its streets" is literal and unsupported.
- D) "Unreliable" memories is too negative; the passage frames the change as perceptual, not as a memory failure. **TRAP ALERT** ☹ D is tempting because it addresses memory, but the passage doesn't call memories unreliable — it says the narrator's frame of reference changed.

KEY INSIGHT 💡 "Nothing here had changed but himself" = his growth altered his perception.

FAST METHOD ✂ Find the thesis sentence: "nothing here had changed but himself."

Q8. Correct Answer: A

REASONING: The passage says liquid water could exist "if atmospheric circulation were strong enough to distribute heat." This directly links habitability to the atmosphere's capacity to transfer thermal energy.

WHY EACH WRONG: - B) Distance from other stars is irrelevant to heat distribution on a single planet. - C) A metallic core is not mentioned in the passage. - D) Tidally locked planets don't rotate from the observer's perspective; one side always faces the star.

KEY INSIGHT 💡 "Atmospheric circulation" to "distribute heat" = atmosphere transferring thermal energy.

FAST METHOD ✂ The passage already states the condition. Match it.

Q9. Correct Answer: B

REASONING: Participation was voluntary and driven by "parents who had actively sought additional support." This self-selection confound makes it impossible to separate the effect of tutoring from the effect of having highly involved parents.

WHY EACH WRONG: - A) Tutor training is not questioned in the passage. - C) True statement but irrelevant to the study's design flaw. - D) Expansion recommendation is a policy question, not a design limitation.

KEY INSIGHT 💡 Self-selection bias: the characteristic that led families to enroll (parental involvement) could itself explain the outcome.

FAST METHOD ✂ Voluntary enrollment + active parents = can't separate tutoring effect from parent effect.

Q10. Correct Answer: D

REASONING: Railroads spread "newspapers and standardized educational materials to rural areas." This goes beyond economic goods to cultural and intellectual unification.

WHY EACH WRONG:

- A) "At the expense of rural communities" is not supported; the passage says rural areas received benefits.
- B) Resistance to educational materials is not mentioned.
- C) Military preparation is not mentioned. **KEY INSIGHT** 💡 "More than accelerate the movement of goods" = also cultural/intellectual effects.

FAST METHOD ✂ The passage explicitly says railroads did "more than" move goods → not just economic.

Q11. Correct Answer: C

REASONING: Ferreira attributed the lab/field discrepancy to the lab's "failure to replicate certain variables present in natural marine environments." This means labs are useful but don't fully capture real-world complexity.

WHY EACH WRONG:

- A) "Fundamentally unsuitable" overstates — the polymers did degrade, just more slowly.
- B) This reverses the finding: degradation was slower, not faster, in natural seawater.
- D) Using freshwater would move further from ocean conditions, not closer. **KEY INSIGHT** 💡 Lab ≠ field because of uncontrolled variables → labs are useful but limited.

FAST METHOD ✂ The passage criticizes the lab's simplifications, not the polymer or the lab method entirely.

Q12. Correct Answer: B

REASONING: Oil paint's slow drying allowed "unprecedented realism" of textures, encouraging artists to choose subjects "where the display of material detail was ____." Secular subjects like portraits showcased material detail, so detail display was the central objective.

WHY EACH WRONG: - A) "Less important" contradicts the logic; the passage says oil paint encouraged focus on detail. - C) "Discouraged by academies" is not mentioned and contradicts the described trend. - D) Oil paint's advantages over tempera are the point; the blank isn't about tempera.

KEY INSIGHT ⚡ The logic flows: new capability → new subjects chosen → because detail was central to those subjects.

FAST METHOD ⚡ Artists chose subjects that showcased the new medium's strength → detail was the goal.

Q13. Correct Answer: A

REASONING: The critics note that active commuters live in neighborhoods with "lower crime rates, shorter commute distances, and more green space." If green space independently boosts well-being, then the apparent benefit of active commuting could be a neighborhood effect, not a commuting effect — directly supporting the critics' concern about confounding variables.

WHY EACH WRONG: - B) This would support Whitfield's claim, not the critics' concern. - C) Sample size adequacy doesn't address confounding variables. - D) Switching behavior during the study is interesting but doesn't directly address the neighborhood confound.

KEY INSIGHT ⚡ The critics' concern = confounding variables (neighborhood quality). Supporting that concern means showing neighborhood quality independently explains the outcome.

FAST METHOD ⚡ Critics say: maybe it's the neighborhood, not the commute. A shows the neighborhood matters independently.

Q14. Correct Answer: D

REASONING: Water transmits sound well but absorbs radio waves. Engineers chose sound over radio because of this physical difference. The choice reflects water's properties as a transmission medium.

WHY EACH WRONG:

- A) Radio waves don't travel at the same speed in water and air; they're absorbed in water.
- B) Sound does travel through denser substances; the passage says water helps, not hinders, sound.
- C) Detectability by marine animals is irrelevant to engineering design choices. **KEY INSIGHT** ⚡ The passage gives two facts: sound travels well in water; radio waves don't. The conclusion connects them.

FAST METHOD ⚡ Good for sound + bad for radio = sound is the better choice in water.

Q15. Correct Answer: B

REASONING: The narrator compares her grandmother to "a conductor" who works through "exquisite attention" rather than "force," and says "expertise could look indistinguishable from tenderness." This frames skill as graceful and intuitive.

WHY EACH WRONG: - A) "Wishes she would share" implies frustration not present in the passage's admiring tone. - C) Decline with age is not mentioned; the passage is purely admiring. - D) "Selfishness" contradicts the tender, admiring tone.

KEY INSIGHT ⚡ "Expertise could look indistinguishable from tenderness" = skill appears effortless and graceful.

FAST METHOD ⚡ The conductor metaphor and "tenderness" = graceful expertise, not mechanical skill.

Q16. Correct Answer: C

REASONING: The manuscripts "remained unstudied" because they were in "scripts and languages unfamiliar to European scholars who dominated the field." This shows that the dominant researchers' linguistic limitations — a form of bias — created gaps in scholarly attention.

WHY EACH WRONG: - A) The passage says the library "rivalled" European institutions, implying equal importance. - B) "Deliberately suppressed" implies conspiracy; the passage attributes neglect to unfamiliarity, not intent. - D) "Primarily used for religious instruction" is unsupported and unrelated to the neglect issue.

KEY INSIGHT ♀ Whose expertise dominates a field determines what gets studied. Linguistic/cultural bias = systematic gap.

FAST METHOD ⚡ European scholars didn't know the languages → manuscripts ignored → bias caused the gap.

MEDIUM (Q17-Q48)

Q17. Correct Answer: B

REASONING: Removing otters → urchin explosion → kelp destruction → loss of shelter/food for fish and invertebrates. This chain crosses multiple trophic levels. The answer defines "trophic cascade."

WHY EACH WRONG: - A) Plant recovery contradicts what happened (kelp was destroyed). - C) "Increased biodiversity" contradicts the described losses. - D) No replacement species is mentioned; the passage describes disruption, not substitution.

KEY INSIGHT ♀ One species removed → effects cascade through the food web = trophic cascade definition.

FAST METHOD ⚡ The passage literally illustrates a chain of disruptions. Match the definition.

Q18. Correct Answer: D

REASONING: Okoro says compulsory voting achieves high turnout but voters "may do so without researching candidates." More ballots ≠ better participation quality.

WHY EACH WRONG:

- A) "Guarantees" accurate representation overstates; Okoro questions participation quality.
- B) Benefiting incumbents is not mentioned.
- C) The passage doesn't claim voluntary voters are more informed, just that compulsory voters might not be.

TRAP ALERT ☹ A sounds like the logical conclusion of high turnout, but Okoro's point is that turnout ≠ engagement.

KEY INSIGHT ♀ Quantity of participation (turnout) ≠ quality of participation (informed voting).

FAST METHOD ⚡ Required voting → more ballots but not necessarily more informed ballots.

Q19. Correct Answer: A

REASONING: Bilinguals had "fewer errors but did not complete it faster." Fewer errors = greater precision/accuracy. Same speed = no velocity improvement. This is precision of executive control, not processing speed.

WHY EACH WRONG: - B) "Temporary" and "decline with age" are not discussed. - C) "All cognitive abilities" and "processing speed" are explicitly contradicted (speed didn't improve). - D) "Greater familiarity with standardized testing" is an unfounded external explanation.

KEY INSIGHT ♀ Fewer errors = precision. Same speed = no velocity gain. Precision without speed = accuracy of control.

FAST METHOD ✂ Error rate improved, speed didn't → precision benefit, not speed benefit.

Q20. Correct Answer: C

REASONING: The Hoover Dam's unprecedented scale created a curing-heat problem negligible in smaller structures. The solution (columns + cooling pipes) was novel. This illustrates that large scale creates new problems requiring new techniques.

WHY EACH WRONG: - A) Cost comparison is not made in the passage. - B) The concrete chemistry isn't described as different; the problem was scale. - D) No comparison between river water and industrial coolants is made.

KEY INSIGHT 💡 Scale creates problems that don't exist at small sizes → new solutions needed.

FAST METHOD ✂ Unprecedented volume → unprecedented problem → novel technique.

Q21. Correct Answer: D

REASONING: Khoury says switching is "not linguistic confusion but rather a sophisticated sensitivity to the social and contextual associations each language carries." This means choices are deliberate and context-driven.

WHY EACH WRONG:

- A) "Lack sufficient vocabulary" is exactly what Khoury argues against ("not linguistic confusion").
- B) "Unique to trilingual communities in Beirut" is an overgeneralization not made by Khoury.
- C) "Transitional phase" implies it will stop; Khoury presents it as a stable, sophisticated practice. **KEY INSIGHT** 💡 The passage explicitly contrasts "confusion" with "sophisticated sensitivity" → deliberate, not deficient.

FAST METHOD ✂ "Not confusion but sensitivity" directly maps to "deliberate and contextually motivated."

Q22. Correct Answer: A

REASONING: Ramos "conceded" an alternative explanation. The answer must be a plausible alternative. A offers a behavioral explanation (predation avoidance) that could produce the same non-overlapping trackway pattern without requiring seasonal separation.

WHY EACH WRONG: - B) Ramos uses trackways as evidence; calling them "unreliable" would undermine his own work. - C) "Incapable of coexisting" is too extreme and contradicts the shared landscape evidence. - D) "Proves they traveled together" contradicts the observed non-overlapping pattern.

TRAP ALERT 🚩 C sounds ecologically reasonable but goes far beyond what Ramos would concede; he accepts coexistence but questions timing.

KEY INSIGHT 💡 "Conceded" = acknowledged a competing explanation. The alternative must explain the same pattern differently.

FAST METHOD ✂ Same observation (non-overlapping tracks) + different mechanism (predation avoidance vs. seasonal timing).

Q23. Correct Answer: C

REASONING: Gift values have risen (cost to families), families go into debt, but more expensive gifts don't make couples happier. Cost up + benefit flat = cost without proportional benefit.

WHY EACH WRONG:

- A) Higher divorce rates are not mentioned.
- B) Marriage importance is not discussed.
- D) The passage specifically discusses weddings, not "all ceremonial occasions." **KEY INSIGHT** 💡 Rising costs

+ no measurable happiness gain = financial burden without proportional return.

FAST METHOD ✂ More spending → same happiness = spending doesn't help.

Q24. Correct Answer: A

REASONING: The technique produces better quality (fewer defects, lower temperature) but is slower (one-tenth the rate). The tradeoff is quality vs. speed. The decision depends on whether the quality gain justifies the speed loss for a given application.

WHY EACH WRONG: - B) Replacing gallium nitride entirely is a separate question, not the passage's tradeoff. - C) Replication by others doesn't address the manufacturer's adoption decision. - D) Consumer willingness to pay is too indirect; the core tradeoff is quality vs. production rate.

KEY INSIGHT 💡 Any tradeoff decision depends on whether the benefit outweighs the cost for a specific use case.

FAST METHOD ✂ Better quality but slower → worth it depends on the application.

Q25. Correct Answer: B

REASONING: Abiodun says Wyatt's dialogue is not mimicry of real speech (only "half true") but "clarification" — giving characters "the words that real people feel but cannot find." Her genius is illuminating inexpressible emotions.

WHY EACH WRONG: - A) "Emotions that real people rarely experience" misreads the passage; the emotions are common but hard to articulate. - C) Abiodun says verisimilitude is "only half true" and "the less interesting half" — he partially disagrees with admirers. - D) "Never able" is too absolute; the passage says people struggle, not that they permanently can't.

TRAP ALERT ☒ C is tempting because admirers do praise verisimilitude, but Abiodun explicitly corrects this as incomplete.

KEY INSIGHT 💡 "Not mimicry but clarification" = not reproduction of speech but illumination of emotion.

FAST METHOD ✂ Abiodun corrects the admirers: the real achievement is articulating the inarticulate.

Q26. Correct Answer: D

REASONING: Two populations use different techniques; juveniles learn by "observing and imitating adults." Different environments → different behaviors → learned through social transmission = culturally transmitted knowledge shaped by environment.

WHY EACH WRONG:

- A) "Genetically predisposed" contradicts the social learning evidence.
- B) No efficiency comparison is made, and "solitary species" are not mentioned.
- C) "Unable to learn" is unsupported; the passage doesn't test cross-population learning. **KEY INSIGHT** 💡 Social learning + environment-specific techniques = culture, not genetics.

FAST METHOD ✂ Learned from adults + different in different habitats = culturally transmitted, environmentally shaped.

Q27. Correct Answer: C

REASONING: Property values rise most near stations (benefiting owners), but rental prices also rise (displacing renters). Benefits concentrated near stations + renters displaced = benefits for owners, costs for renters.

WHY EACH WRONG:

- A) Renters are hurt by rising rents, not primarily benefited.

- B) "Distributed equally" contradicts the uneven 20% vs. 3% distribution.
- D) 3% increase beyond half a mile means benefits don't "diminish entirely." **KEY INSIGHT** 💡 Same investment creates winners (nearby owners) and losers (nearby renters).

FAST METHOD ✂ Values up → good for owners. Rents up → bad for renters. Uneven distribution.

Q28. Correct Answer: B

REASONING: Gupta's argument: printing existed in East Asia without causing a Reformation → technology alone isn't sufficient → social/political/economic conditions also matter. This means Chen overemphasizes technology and underestimates context.

WHY EACH WRONG: - A) Gupta doesn't say the press had "no meaningful impact" — he says it wasn't sufficient alone. - C) He doesn't claim East Asian printing was "more effective." - D) He doesn't claim Luther would have achieved the same influence without printing.

TRAP ALERT 🚩 A is too extreme. Gupta acknowledges the press "accelerated" ideas — he just says it wasn't sufficient.

KEY INSIGHT 💡 Same technology + different context = different outcome → context matters at least as much as technology.

FAST METHOD ✂ Gupta's counterexample (East Asia) shows technology alone ≠ Reformation.

Q29. Correct Answer: D

REASONING: Lab: 87% reduction. Field (plant tissue): 34%. Holm hypothesizes other microorganisms interact with the compound to reduce its effectiveness. This means microbial communities modulate the compound's action.

WHY EACH WRONG:

- A) "Unlikely to have any practical applications" is too extreme; the compound still showed 34% reduction.
- B) The passage doesn't claim the compound is produced only on birch roots.
- C) "All naturally derived compounds" overgeneralizes from one study. **KEY INSIGHT** 💡 Lab = isolated compound works well. Field = other organisms interfere = microbial community matters.

FAST METHOD ✂ Simple environment → strong effect. Complex environment → weaker effect → complexity matters.

Q30. Correct Answer: C

REASONING: High interruptions → low satisfaction. Zero interruptions → moderate satisfaction. Moderate interruptions → highest satisfaction. This is nonlinear (not a straight line down or up).

WHY EACH WRONG: - A) "Always" is contradicted by the finding that zero interruptions < moderate interruptions in satisfaction. - B) Source of interruptions (peers vs. supervisors) is not discussed. - D) Productivity of uninterrupted workers is not described as "least."

KEY INSIGHT 💡 Inverted-U pattern: some interruptions > none, but too many is worst.

FAST METHOD ✂ 5+ interruptions (lowest satisfaction) < 0 interruptions < 2-4 interruptions (highest satisfaction) → nonlinear, inverted-U shape.

Q31. Correct Answer: A

REASONING: After one year: no difference. After five years: thick-coated seeds 72% vs. thin-coated 19%. The thick coating's advantage appears specifically under prolonged cold exposure.

WHY EACH WRONG: - B) Thin-coated seeds survived one year of freezing, so they're not incapable of brief

cold survival. - C) Above-freezing storage is not tested in the passage. - D) "All alpine wildflower species" overgeneralizes from one species.

KEY INSIGHT ⚡ The advantage is time-dependent: no difference at 1 year, huge difference at 5 years → prolonged cold is the key variable.

FAST METHOD ✂ Same at 1 year, divergent at 5 years → thick coating helps specifically with extended cold.

Q32. Correct Answer: A

REASONING: Lavalley considers plot "secondary" to "emotional architecture" and sequences emotions for psychological effect, even overriding plot logic. This means emotional structure is deliberately crafted and can take priority over plot.

WHY EACH WRONG: - B) "Always subordinated" is too absolute; Lavalley says plot is secondary, not irrelevant. - C) Reader preferences are not discussed. - D) "Only emotions" is too narrow; she mentions one example, not a restriction.

KEY INSIGHT ⚡ "Emotional architecture" = deliberate design of emotional sequence. "Not because the plot demanded it" = emotional structure can override plot.

FAST METHOD ✂ She places a scene based on emotional impact, not plot necessity → emotional structure takes priority.

Q33. Correct Answer: D

REASONING: Trees removed for agriculture → topsoil dries out → crops can't survive. The agricultural expansion intended to increase production may destroy the conditions crops need. "Ironically" signals a self-defeating outcome.

WHY EACH WRONG:

- A) "No measurable effect" contradicts the described drying-out mechanism.
- B) "Discovery of unknown water sources" is unsupported and contradicts the drying-out trend.
- C) "Crop varieties that don't require groundwater" is not discussed. **TRAP ALERT** 🚩 The word "ironically" is the biggest clue — it signals a self-defeating or paradoxical outcome.

KEY INSIGHT ⚡ Irony = the action (clearing trees for farming) destroys the condition (moist topsoil) needed for its own success.

FAST METHOD ✂ "Ironically" → the action defeats its own purpose.

Q34. Correct Answer: C

REASONING: Bjornsson argues that visible damage "draws the viewer's attention away from the composition as the artist designed it." This is his rebuttal: leaving damage visible also distorts the experience, just differently.

WHY EACH WRONG:

- A) Bjornsson advocates for reconstruction, not avoiding all restoration.
- B) Digital imaging is not mentioned by Bjornsson.
- D) This is a compromise Bjornsson doesn't make; he broadly supports reconstruction. **KEY INSIGHT** ⚡ Bjornsson's core argument: inaction (leaving damage) also distorts, not just action (reconstruction).

FAST METHOD ✂ Morales says reconstruction distorts. Bjornsson says so does visible damage → both sides have distortion risk.

Q35. Correct Answer: B

REASONING: Fujimoto proposes convective cells cause erratic brightness. If computer simulations of convective cells produce matching brightness patterns, that's direct evidence the mechanism can produce the observed effect.

WHY EACH WRONG: - A) Binary star systems introduce a different cause, not supporting the convective cell hypothesis. - C) Other stars being regular doesn't support the cause of irregularity. - D) Chemical composition differences suggest a different mechanism, not convective cells.

KEY INSIGHT 💡 To support a proposed mechanism, show that the mechanism produces the observed outcome (even in simulation).

FAST METHOD ✂ Hypothesis: X causes Y. Support: simulating X produces Y.

Q36. Correct Answer: D

REASONING: Spinach absorbed extra iron but NOT extra zinc, even when zinc was abundant. If the plant has selective uptake, then adding a mineral to soil doesn't guarantee the plant will absorb more of it.

WHY EACH WRONG:

- A) "Reliably increase" for "all crops" contradicts the selective mechanism shown.
- B) Competition between iron and zinc is not Obi's proposed mechanism; she says selectivity, not competition.
- C) "Only vegetable species" overgeneralizes from one study. **TRAP ALERT** 🚫 B sounds plausible but introduces a specific mechanism (competition for pathways) that the passage doesn't describe. Obi says "selective uptake," which is broader.

KEY INSIGHT 💡 Selective uptake = the plant controls what it absorbs, so soil enrichment doesn't automatically translate to plant enrichment.

FAST METHOD ✂ More zinc in soil ≠ more zinc in plant → enriching soil doesn't guarantee plant absorption.

Q37. Correct Answer: B

REASONING: Nishida says textile exports (by women) financed railroads and industry, and that this is "often overlooked." She "contends" the narrative should include these contributions.

WHY EACH WRONG: - A) "Same pace" contradicts Nishida's claim that textile revenue financed industrialization. - C) "More sophisticated" is not argued; she argues for recognition, not superiority. - D) "Deliberately minimized" implies conspiracy; Nishida says "overlooked," not deliberately hidden.

KEY INSIGHT 💡 "Overlooked" → should be included = expand the narrative.

FAST METHOD ✂ Overlooked contributions + "therefore contends" → narrative should be broadened.

Q38. Correct Answer: C

REASONING: Display nests attract mates but also predators (higher predation). Incubation nests have equal predation across all males, suggesting they're protected by concealment and separation. The cost (predation) is confined to display nests, not incubation nests.

WHY EACH WRONG:

- A) Reproductive success would require data on offspring survival, which isn't provided.
- B) If predators couldn't distinguish, predation rates would be similar for both nest types.
- D) Display nest predation alone doesn't determine reproductive success; incubation nest survival matters.

KEY INSIGHT 💡 Different predation rates for two nest types → the costly display nest attracts predators, but the concealed incubation nest is protected.

FAST METHOD ✂ Display nest: high predation, varies by elaborateness. Incubation nest: equal predation = separately concealed.

Q39. Correct Answer: C

REASONING: Kassem says "authentic" dishes are themselves products of "centuries of cross-cultural borrowing." Picking a point in time as the "authentic" form is arbitrary because the dish was always changing, before and after that point.

WHY EACH WRONG:

- A) Consumer preferences are not discussed.
- B) The passage explicitly says tomatoes were introduced in the sixteenth century, implying change after that.
- D) Food historians' research habits are not the topic. **KEY INSIGHT** 💡 Authenticity requires freezing a moment, but cuisine is always flowing.

FAST METHOD ✂ "Cross-cultural borrowing and adaptation" = ongoing change → any frozen moment is arbitrary.

Q40. Correct Answer: A

REASONING: If the first group happened to be naturally more persistent (by random chance in assignment), then the 14 vs. 9 minute difference could be due to pre-existing personality traits rather than the essay intervention. This directly undermines the causal conclusion.

WHY EACH WRONG:

- B) Similar discomfort levels don't undermine the conclusion about persistence.
- C) Greater enjoyment could be an effect of the intervention, not a confounder.
- D) Some participants not reading carefully would weaken the treatment's effect, making the difference harder to find — not explaining it. **TRAP ALERT** ⚠ D might seem to weaken the conclusion, but it would actually reduce the observed difference, not create a false one.

KEY INSIGHT 💡 To weaken a causal claim from an experiment, find a confound in the random assignment.

FAST METHOD ✂ If one group was already more persistent, the intervention didn't cause the difference.

Q41. Correct Answer: B

REASONING: Parks increased property values (benefit) but also raised rents, displacing low-income residents (inequitable outcome). Delgado argues for pairing development with affordable housing protections → benefits can be inequitable without policy safeguards.

WHY EACH WRONG: - A) Waterfront vs. non-waterfront comparison is not Delgado's argument. - C) Low-income residents could benefit from parks, but displacement prevents this. - D) "Under any circumstances" is too extreme; Delgado says pair it with protections, not avoid it entirely.

KEY INSIGHT 💡 The argument isn't anti-park; it's pro-equity-in-park-planning.

FAST METHOD ✂ Benefits + displacement → need policy safeguards = economic benefits can be inequitable without protections.

Q42. Correct Answer: D

REASONING: Pheromone draws females to the area. Then acoustic signals determine which male is chosen. Acoustics serve as the fine-grained discrimination tool after pheromone does the broad attraction.

WHY EACH WRONG:

- A) "Irrelevant" contradicts the described role of pheromones in drawing females to the area.
- B) Pheromone detection range is not discussed.
- C) No chemical difference in pheromones by click volume is mentioned. **KEY INSIGHT** 💡 Two-stage process: pheromone = attract to area; acoustics = discriminate among individuals.

FAST METHOD ✂ First filter: pheromone (broad). Second filter: acoustics (fine) = secondary criterion.

Q43. Correct Answer: B

REASONING: If West African ironworking dates to 800 BCE, centuries before previously known West African sites, this undermines the theory that all West African ironworking diffused from East Africa. It could have developed independently.

WHY EACH WRONG: - A) "Simultaneously in multiple locations around the world" overgeneralizes from one regional discovery. - C) Trade connections would support diffusion, not independent development. - D) The passage doesn't say East African ironworking began later; it says the Niger site is earlier than other West African sites.

TRAP ALERT 🚩 A and C go too far. The discovery "complicates" the single-origin theory; it doesn't prove universal independent invention or disprove all contact.

KEY INSIGHT 💡 "Complicates" = provides evidence against, not proof for an alternative. B uses appropriately cautious language ("suggests... may have").

FAST METHOD ✂ Earlier-than-expected site in West Africa → maybe it developed locally, not via East Africa.

Q44. Correct Answer: A

REASONING: Reflective crops offer a cooling benefit but reduce yields by 8–12%. Farmers must weigh cooling vs. lost output. The decision depends on whether the benefit justifies the cost.

WHY EACH WRONG: - B) "Inevitably more profitable" is unsupported and ignores the yield reduction. - C) "Eliminate the need" is too extreme; a 1°C reduction is helpful but not a complete solution. - D) 8–12% yield loss is significant, not negligible.

KEY INSIGHT 💡 Tradeoff questions require answers that acknowledge both sides of the tradeoff.

FAST METHOD ✂ Benefit (cooling) vs. cost (lower yield) → depends on whether benefit justifies the cost.

Q45. Correct Answer: D

REASONING: Ríos attributes repetitive programming to "practical constraints" — rehearsal time, cost, and ticket revenue — not to "inertia." He offers a different explanation for the same phenomenon.

WHY EACH WRONG:

- A) Ríos doesn't agree that inertia is primary; he proposes economics as the cause.
- B) Ríos doesn't argue canonical works are objectively superior; he says they're cheaper to prepare.
- C) Ríos doesn't claim the canon has changed significantly. **KEY INSIGHT** 💡 Same observation, different causal explanation: Banerjee says inertia; Ríos says economics.

FAST METHOD ✂ Banerjee: "institutional inertia." Ríos: "practical constraints." = alternative explanation.

Q46. Correct Answer: C

REASONING: Marzouki proposes disassortative mating buffers against genetic diversity loss in small populations. If simulations show that this mating pattern retains more diversity than random mating in small populations, that directly supports the proposed mechanism.

WHY EACH WRONG:

- A) Mainland populations mating the same way doesn't support the small-population-buffer hypothesis specifically.
- B) Weather events are tangential to the mating-strategy mechanism.
- D) This contradicts the proposal by suggesting a different mating criterion. **KEY INSIGHT** 💡 To support a

proposed mechanism, show that the mechanism produces the claimed outcome under the relevant conditions.

FAST METHOD ✂ Claim: disassortative mating preserves diversity in small populations. Support: simulation confirms this.

Q47. Correct Answer: B

REASONING: Lucien initially assumed Bernard's silence was "incomprehension" — a "blank stillness." Later he learned the silence was from a "mind so crowded with ideas." He mistook abundance for absence.

WHY EACH WRONG: - A) "Correctly identified" contradicts "I understood my error." - C) "Deliberately discouraged" is not mentioned. - D) "Recognized potential" contradicts the fact that he "understood my error" only years later.

KEY INSIGHT ⚡ "I understood my error" = his earlier assessment was wrong. He mistook cognitive richness for cognitive emptiness.

FAST METHOD ✂ Thought silence = emptiness. Actually silence = fullness. Mistook richness for deficiency.

Q48. Correct Answer: A

REASONING: Reminders active: 78% adherence. Reminders removed: 63% ($\approx$ control group's 61%). The improvement disappeared when reminders stopped → reminders help while active but don't create lasting behavior change.

WHY EACH WRONG: - B) $63\% \approx 61\%$, so reminder recipients didn't develop worse habits, just returned to baseline. - C) Cost is not discussed. - D) The reminder system clearly affected behavior while active, so it's not "unrelated to patient behavior."

KEY INSIGHT ⚡ Behavior returned to baseline when the intervention was removed = temporary effect, not lasting change.

FAST METHOD ✂ On: improved. Off: returned to baseline. = temporary boost, not permanent habit.

HARD (Q49-Q80)

Q49. Correct Answer: A

REASONING: Zhou proposes that the companion's strong magnetic field prevents mass transfer. If the companion's magnetic field strength is comparable to stars that DO experience mass transfer, then the magnetic field can't be the protective factor — directly weakening the proposal.

WHY EACH WRONG: - B) The primary star's magnetic field is not part of Zhou's proposal about the companion. - C) Orbital eccentricity is a real factor but doesn't directly address the magnetic field mechanism. - D) If the companion is younger than 3 million years, Zhou's evidence of "stable mass for 3 million years" would be undermined differently — but this attacks the data, not the mechanism.

TRAP ALERT 🚩 D sounds damaging but attacks the premise (length of observation), not the proposed mechanism (magnetic field). A directly attacks the mechanism.

KEY INSIGHT ⚡ To weaken: show the proposed cause is present in cases where the proposed effect doesn't occur.

FAST METHOD ✂ Same magnetic field + mass transfer happens elsewhere → magnetic field isn't what's preventing it.

Q50. Correct Answer: C

REASONING: Non-experts' ratings dropped 2.3 points. Experts' ratings dropped less, even with equally high

initial ratings. This means experts had genuine understanding (partially withstood the explanation challenge), while non-experts had superficial confidence.

WHY EACH WRONG:

- A) The passage shows the illusion is about lack of knowledge (non-experts fall more), not just general overconfidence.
- B) "Professional pride" is a motivational explanation not suggested by the passage.
- D) Calling the method invalid would undermine the entire study, which the passage presents as informative.

KEY INSIGHT 💡 Same initial confidence + different drops = different underlying understanding. Experts have more substance behind their confidence.

FAST METHOD ⚡ Both groups start high. Experts drop less. = Experts' confidence is better grounded.

Q51. Correct Answer: D

REASONING: Text 1's author (Diallo) would need to address Eriksson's confound (economic decline). The strongest response acknowledges the confound but points to additional evidence — municipalities with surviving newspapers in similar economic conditions show better governance, which would isolate the newspaper's independent effect.

WHY EACH WRONG:

- A) Denying any relationship between economics and spending/corruption is implausible and unnecessary.
- B) Saying closures are "never caused" by economics is too absolute.
- C) Saying newspapers "rarely report on misconduct" would undermine Diallo's own argument. **TRAP ALERT** 🚩 A and B are extreme absolute claims. D is the moderate, evidence-based response.

KEY INSIGHT 💡 The best response to a confound argument is a comparison that controls for the confound.

FAST METHOD ⚡ Eriksson: maybe it's the economy. Diallo's best response: even controlling for economy, newspapers matter.

Q52. Correct Answer: C

REASONING: When participants were told to switch their perception, brain activity shifted to match the new interpretation. This means conscious intent redirected which neural regions processed the same stimulus → conscious awareness can redirect perceptual processing.

WHY EACH WRONG: - A) "Fixed at the moment of initial perception" is directly contradicted by the successful switching. - B) The study tested conscious switching, not prior familiarity. - D) "Perceived identically by all viewers" contradicts the study's premise.

KEY INSIGHT 💡 Same stimulus + different conscious intent = different neural activation = consciousness can steer perception.

FAST METHOD ⚡ Told to switch → brain activity switched → conscious control over perception.

Q53. Correct Answer: D

REASONING: Net employment fell only 12%, but clerical workers were eliminated while analytical roles grew. Those without college degrees were less likely to be retrained → the modest net effect masks uneven distribution by education level.

WHY EACH WRONG:

- A) "Uniformly benefits all workers" is directly contradicted by the education-based disparity.
- B) What the firm "should have" done is a normative recommendation not implied by the analysis.
- C) "Inherently less capable" is a prejudicial claim not supported; the passage says less likely to be selected, not less capable. **KEY INSIGHT** 💡 Aggregate net effect can mask distributional inequality. Modest total

change ≠ equal impact across groups.

FAST METHOD ✂ Total jobs: −12%. But clerical (less educated) workers hit hardest = uneven distribution.

Q54. Correct Answer: B

REASONING: Park's counterargument: the climatic conditions for wetland expansion "were present at similar levels during earlier periods" when methane didn't rise. If the same natural conditions existed earlier without causing a methane rise, then a new factor (rice cultivation) is needed to explain why it rose after 3,000 BCE.

WHY EACH WRONG: - A) Park is arguing against natural wetlands as the sole cause, not for them. - C) Methane-producing microorganisms certainly existed before 3,000 BCE in wetlands; their absence isn't claimed. - D) Park uses ice core data as his evidence; he wouldn't undermine his own methodology.

KEY INSIGHT ⚡ Same conditions earlier + no effect then → conditions alone are insufficient → something new (human activity) is the additional factor.

FAST METHOD ✂ Counterfactual reasoning: same cause existed before without the effect → cause is insufficient alone.

Q55. Correct Answer: C

REASONING: Villanueva compares math to symphonies and legal codes (human-made, not discovered) and calls mathematical truths "human artifacts" with "apparent inevitability" being "a trick of habit." He questions whether math describes a pre-existing reality.

WHY EACH WRONG:

- A) This is the opposite of Villanueva's position.
- B) Calling math "less rigorous" is not his argument; he questions its ontological status, not its rigor.
- D) He says symphonies are "made, not found" — the opposite of discovered. **KEY INSIGHT** ⚡ "Apparent inevitability a trick of habit" = the feeling that math is discovered may be an illusion.

FAST METHOD ✂ "Human artifacts dressed in the costume of necessity" → math might be human-made, not pre-existing.

Q56. Correct Answer: D

REASONING: Nakamura hypothesizes that "age-related decline in immune cell function limits the duration." If elderly patients have fewer of the specific immune cells responsible for sustaining antibody production, that directly supports her claim that immune cell decline is the mechanism.

WHY EACH WRONG:

- A) Exercise effects are a different variable, not the immune cell mechanism.
- B) If younger patients without the adjuvant also maintained levels, it would suggest the adjuvant isn't responsible.
- C) Broad effectiveness against multiple pathogens doesn't explain the duration difference. **KEY INSIGHT** ⚡ To support a mechanistic hypothesis, show the proposed mechanism is present/absent as predicted.

FAST METHOD ✂ Hypothesis: fewer immune cells → shorter duration. Support: elderly do have fewer of those cells.

Q57. Correct Answer: B

REASONING: Okonkwo says the perception of hostility comes from "conflating the rawness of materials with a rawness of intent." This means judging a material's aesthetic (cold concrete) can lead to wrong conclusions about the architect's purpose (fostering community).

WHY EACH WRONG: - A) "All Brutalist buildings" overgeneralizes; Okonkwo discusses "many" and

"particularly those" in post-independence nations. - C) "Universally admired" is contradicted by the criticism discussed in the passage. - D) "Unaware of how their designs would be perceived" is not Okonkwo's claim; she says the perception is a misreading.

KEY INSIGHT ⚡ Material appearance → misinterpreted intent. The aesthetic of the surface misleads about the purpose underneath.

FAST METHOD ✂ "Conflating rawness of materials with rawness of intent" = judging purpose from appearance.

Q58. Correct Answer: C

REASONING: The model fails on proteins with intrinsically disordered regions because it assumes "a single lowest-energy configuration." The fix must address this assumption by allowing for multiple structural states.

WHY EACH WRONG:

- A) Removing difficult proteins from the test doesn't improve the model; it hides the limitation.
- B) Increasing database size doesn't fix the model's fundamental assumption.
- D) Replacing the energy approach "entirely" is too extreme; the model works for 412/500 proteins. **KEY INSIGHT** ⚡ The limitation is structural: the model assumes one fixed shape when some regions are inherently flexible. The fix must accommodate flexibility.

FAST METHOD ✂ Model assumes one shape. Some proteins have multiple shapes. Fix: allow multiple shapes.

Q59. Correct Answer: A

REASONING: Lindqvist says unreliable narration "predates modernism by centuries" (not a new invention) but that modernism made it more subtle (a refinement). Azubuike correctly identifies the interpretive demands but wrongly calls it an innovation — it's a refinement of something old.

WHY EACH WRONG:

- B) Lindqvist says unreliable narration existed before modernism, so he wouldn't agree it "originated" there.
- C) Modernist fiction didn't "abandon" unreliable narration; Lindqvist says it refined the technique.
- D) Lindqvist acknowledges the interpretive demands; he says they're "more demanding." **TRAP ALERT** 🚩 B is tempting because Lindqvist does think Azubuike is wrong about origins, but B says Lindqvist agrees about origins and disagrees about significance — the opposite of his position.

KEY INSIGHT ⚡ Lindqvist: right about the effect (interpretive demands), wrong about the origin (not new, just refined).

FAST METHOD ✂ Existed before + modernism made it subtler = refinement, not invention.

Q60. Correct Answer: D

REASONING: Lab: 90%+ removal. Full-scale: 55%. Discrepancy explained by larger/more variable water volumes and seasonal temperature fluctuations. The gap reflects challenges of scale and environmental variability.

WHY EACH WRONG:

- A) "Abandoned" is too extreme; the technology still removes 55%.
- B) Directly contradicted by the passage stating temperature affects microbial communities.
- C) Pharmaceutical risk is not discussed. **KEY INSIGHT** ⚡ Lab conditions are controlled and small-scale. Real-world conditions are variable and large-scale. The gap is predictable.

FAST METHOD ✂ Lab ≠ field because of scale + variability = the performance gap is structural.

Q61. Correct Answer: C

REASONING: Glassmakers were legally prohibited from leaving, but "several did flee." The knowledge was so commercially valuable that individuals accepted the legal risk and personal danger of defying the law.

WHY EACH WRONG:

- A) Glassmakers fleeing means the secrets did spread — "successfully prevented" is false.
- B) Independent development elsewhere is not discussed.
- D) Ferrante calls it an "emerging concept," not a fully formed modern patent system. **KEY INSIGHT** 💡 Law restricts. People still flee. → Value of knowledge > deterrent power of law.

FAST METHOD ✂ Prohibition + people fled anyway → incentives overcame the legal barrier.

Q62. Correct Answer: D

REASONING: Four-year-olds: always equal. Six-year-olds: merit-based only when framed as "earned rewards," not as "gifts." This means merit-based reasoning isn't just age-dependent; it's activated by contextual framing.

WHY EACH WRONG:

- A) "No concept of fairness" is contradicted by four-year-olds' consistent equality (a form of fairness).
- B) Cultural variation is not tested in this study.
- C) Six-year-olds divided equally in the "gift" condition, so they're clearly capable. **KEY INSIGHT** 💡 Same children, same materials, different label → different behavior. The label triggers the merit reasoning.

FAST METHOD ✂ "Earned rewards" → unequal. "Gifts" → equal. Same kids. = framing activates the principle.

Q63. Correct Answer: B

REASONING: Medina says Liang controlled for known indoor sources but didn't measure actual indoor pollutant concentrations. Without direct measurement, unmeasured indoor pollutants (VOCs) could be contributing, making outdoor pollution's contribution appear larger than it truly is.

WHY EACH WRONG: - A) The study used clinical diagnoses and tracking, not self-reports — no such flaw is mentioned. - C) Medina praises the study as "rigorous"; sample size is not his concern. - D) Medina doesn't say the study should have ignored outdoor pollution.

KEY INSIGHT 💡 Controlled for sources ≠ measured actual levels. The gap between proxy controls and direct measurement could inflate the outdoor pollution estimate.

FAST METHOD ✂ Controlled for smoking/pets (sources) but didn't measure VOC levels directly → could miss indoor pollutants → inflate outdoor attribution.

Q64. Correct Answer: A

REASONING: Eyes are tuned to species-specific bioluminescent wavelengths, enabling mate identification. If eyes serve mate identification, then natural selection maintains functional eyes because they are essential for reproduction — an essential role.

WHY EACH WRONG: - B) The passage doesn't establish evolutionary sequence between bioluminescence and eyes. - C) "All deep-sea organisms" overgeneralizes. - D) "Structurally identical" to surface fish eyes is not claimed.

KEY INSIGHT 💡 Trait (functional eyes) persists because it serves a critical function (mate identification) → maintained by natural selection.

FAST METHOD ✂ Eyes in the dark → why? → species-specific light detection for mating → essential function → selection maintains them.

Q65. Correct Answer: C

REASONING: Kamara says deliberation with like-minded groups → polarization. She blames "ideologically homogeneous groups." The implication: the effect depends on group composition. Deliberation with diverse groups might not polarize.

WHY EACH WRONG:

- A) "Inherently harmful" and "abandoned" are too extreme; Kamara criticizes the design, not the concept.
- B) "Permanently" is too strong; the passage describes a tendency, not a permanent change.
- D) The passage doesn't limit group polarization to democratic societies. **KEY INSIGHT** 💡 The problem isn't deliberation itself but the composition of the deliberating group. Design matters.

FAST METHOD ✂ Homogeneous groups → polarization. Therefore, composition is the critical variable.

Q66. Correct Answer: D

REASONING: Mass-independent fractionation (MIF) = no ozone = no oxygen. MIF signal weakens 50 million years before the Great Oxidation Event. If the signal that indicates no oxygen starts to weaken, small amounts of oxygen may have been building up.

WHY EACH WRONG:

- A) "Suddenly and without preceding changes" is contradicted by the gradual weakening signal.
- B) UV levels being higher doesn't explain the weakening of MIF signal.
- C) The method works for older rocks (the 2.5-billion-year analysis succeeds); only the transitional period shows weakening. **KEY INSIGHT** 💡 Weakening of the "no oxygen" signal = oxygen starting to appear = gradual transition, not sudden event.

FAST METHOD ✂ Signal for "no oxygen" starts fading before the Oxidation Event → oxygen was slowly building up.

Q67. Correct Answer: A

REASONING: Italian-English bilinguals were slower processing "camera" (which means "room" in Italian) even in an all-English context. If Italian meanings interfered in a purely English context, both languages must have been active simultaneously.

WHY EACH WRONG: - B) The passage shows a specific delay for ambiguous words, not a general slowdown for all words. - C) Directly contradicted by the observed interference. - D) Context clues were absent (English-only context), yet interference still occurred.

KEY INSIGHT 💡 Cross-language interference in a monolingual context = both languages are always "on."

FAST METHOD ✂ English-only context + Italian meaning still interfered → both languages active simultaneously.

Q68. Correct Answer: B

REASONING: Larsson agrees with Diop's Yellowstone example but says it doesn't generalize because Yellowstone is "unusually large, well-protected" with "minimal human settlement." In human-dominated landscapes, rewilding creates conflict. He suggests habitat restoration may work better in those contexts.

WHY EACH WRONG:

- A) Larsson doesn't ignore Yellowstone's benefits; he acknowledges them.
- C) "Never produced benefits" contradicts Larsson's acceptance of the Yellowstone success.
- D) "Always more effective... regardless of characteristics" is too absolute; Larsson argues context matters.

KEY INSIGHT 💡 Larsson's critique is about generalizability, not principle. The idea works in ideal conditions but not in human-dominated landscapes.

FAST METHOD ✂ Right in principle, but practical constraints limit applicability.

Q69. Correct Answer: D

REASONING: Composite: better initially (35% more energy absorption, 40% lighter) but degrades faster (50% decline after 200 cycles vs. 10% for aluminum). For long-term use, the initial advantage may be consumed by faster degradation.

WHY EACH WRONG:

- A) "Irrelevant to real-world applications" dismisses the very test that reveals the limitation.
- B) "Universally superior in every respect" ignores the composite's initial advantages.
- C) "Heal spontaneously" is unsupported. **KEY INSIGHT** ⚡ Initial performance ≠ long-term performance. Degradation rate matters for durability applications.

FAST METHOD ✂ Better at first but degrades faster → may not hold the advantage long-term.

Q70. Correct Answer: B

REASONING: Holmgren "cautioned against interpreting this ability as extraordinary in any general cognitive sense." He implies the naming system itself (encoding physical traits, lineage, behavior) provides a structured framework for recall — domain expertise, not raw memory power.

WHY EACH WRONG: - A) "Formal education in memory techniques" is not mentioned. - C) Other herders' practices are tangential to explaining why this ability isn't "extraordinary." - D) 300 names with detailed associated information is beyond normal range without a framework; the point is the framework makes it achievable.

KEY INSIGHT ⚡ The mnemonic structure of the naming system turns raw memory into organized knowledge → domain expertise, not exceptional general memory.

FAST METHOD ✂ The system organizes information → recall is structured, not superhuman.

Q71. Correct Answer: A

REASONING: Inactivating one gene → intermediate compound accumulated → it had antifungal properties absent from the final product. Biosynthetic pathways produce intermediates that may have distinct, useful activities → untapped pharmaceutical potential.

WHY EACH WRONG: - B) The final product is herbicidal, not antifungal; they're different activities, not attributable to the intermediate. - C) "All soil bacteria" overgeneralizes. - D) "Always results" overgeneralizes from one instance.

KEY INSIGHT ⚡ Pathway intermediates ≠ final product in biological activity → exploring intermediates could reveal new pharmaceuticals.

FAST METHOD ✂ Intermediate ≠ final product in activity. One gene inactivated → new activity discovered → pathways contain hidden pharmacological treasures.

Q72. Correct Answer: C

REASONING: Volkov argues models should also explain why things happen, not just predict that they will. Newtonian mechanics' false assumptions (about gravity) prevent it from predicting phenomena like gravitational lensing — exactly illustrating Volkov's point that false assumptions create predictive blind spots.

WHY EACH WRONG:

- A) Newtonian mechanics is still widely used in engineering.
- B) They're not equally accurate; general relativity corrects Newtonian predictions in extreme conditions.
- D) The choice of example is Engel's; suggesting a different one doesn't address the argument. **KEY INSIGHT** ⚡ Engel's own example can be turned against her: Newtonian mechanics' false assumptions cause it to fail at

gravitational lensing — showing why explanatory accuracy matters.

FAST METHOD ✂ Volkov would judo Engel's example: the very case she cites actually shows the limits of prediction-only evaluation.

Q73. Correct Answer: D

REASONING: Junior employees lost informal interaction → lost confidence on nonroutine tasks. Senior employees were unaffected because they already possessed the tacit knowledge. The loss disproportionately affected those who still needed to acquire expertise through proximity.

WHY EACH WRONG:

- A) The passage says formal training continued but didn't prevent the confidence decline → formal ≠ sufficient.
- B) "Ceased entirely" is too absolute; the passage says informal interaction was reduced, not eliminated.
- C) "Preferred working independently" isn't stated; they were unaffected because they already had the knowledge. **KEY INSIGHT** 💡 Tacit knowledge is transmitted through proximity. Junior workers depend on it most. Removing proximity → junior workers suffer disproportionately.

FAST METHOD ✂ Juniors need informal learning. Remote work removed informal learning. Juniors suffered. Seniors already had it.

Q74. Correct Answer: B

REASONING: Alvarez proposes that thickening tube walls insulate the lava, preventing heat loss. If measurements show walls progressively thicken and heat loss decreases along the tube's length, that directly confirms the proposed mechanism.

WHY EACH WRONG: - A) Lower eruption temperatures → shorter tubes supports conventional models but doesn't directly test the wall-insulation mechanism. - C) Mars's lower temperatures would increase heat loss, explaining shorter tubes without confirming insulation. - D) Same chemistry but different tube lengths would suggest chemistry isn't the factor, not that insulation is.

KEY INSIGHT 💡 Direct measurement of the proposed variable (wall thickness) correlating with the predicted effect (reduced heat loss) is the strongest support.

FAST METHOD ✂ Hypothesis: walls insulate → walls thicken with distance → heat loss drops with distance. Measure that.

Q75. Correct Answer: A

REASONING: Varga says literacy enables both "independent thought" and "passive consumption" — it's a "gateway" to both. She acknowledges the reformers were right that literacy would reshape society but "wrong about the direction" — meaning the outcomes were mixed, not one-directional.

WHY EACH WRONG:

- B) "Failed to produce any democratic benefits" overstates; she says literacy enables independent thought AND passive consumption — both.
- C) "Advertisements are the most influential" is not claimed; they're cited as an example of passive consumption.
- D) "Would have opposed" is not implied; Varga says they were wrong about direction, not that they would have reversed course. **TRAP ALERT** 🚫 A is tempting because Varga is critical, but she acknowledges literacy enables "independent thought" — she says the outcomes are complex, not entirely negative.

KEY INSIGHT 💡 "Same skill" enables both critical engagement and passive consumption → complex consequences, not simple failure.

FAST METHOD ✂ Enables both good and bad uses → complex, not one-sided.

Q76. Correct Answer: A

REASONING: Nearby vents (< 500m) → low overlap. Distant vents (5km+) → sometimes high overlap. Proximity ≠ similarity. Hassan proposes vent fluid chemistry (determined by rock type) is the key variable. This means the chemical environment drives species composition more than geographic distance.

WHY EACH WRONG: - B) "Identical species communities" contradicts the observed variation. - C) Geographic distance is what the passage argues against as the primary determinant. - D) The organisms can survive in different chemistries — they just form different communities.

KEY INSIGHT 💡 Counterintuitive pattern (close ≠ similar, far ≠ different) → distance isn't the driver → chemistry is.

FAST METHOD ✂ Proximity doesn't predict similarity → something else does → chemical environment.

Q77. Correct Answer: C

REASONING: Campbell makes two points: (1) selection bias confounds the evidence for competition's benefits, and (2) mandating competition could harm students who respond poorly. This means the motivational evidence is confounded by self-selection, and universal application could hurt the most vulnerable.

WHY EACH WRONG:

- A) "Reliably produces deeper mastery for all students" is exactly what Campbell disputes.
- B) Campbell doesn't attack standardized assessments as a measure.
- D) Campbell doesn't advocate for total replacement with collaboration; she questions mandatory competition.

KEY INSIGHT 💡 Two-part rebuttal: (1) evidence is confounded, (2) universal mandate could backfire for some students.

FAST METHOD ✂ Self-selection + mandate could harm vulnerable students = confounded evidence + unequal impact.

Q78. Correct Answer: A

REASONING: Kuznetsova's model: neutron star orbits a companion, bursting only when it passes through a plasma cloud. If the orbit is the driver, the interval between burst clusters should match the orbital period — roughly periodic.

WHY EACH WRONG: - B) Non-repeating FRBs are not addressed by a model specific to repeating FRBs. - C) Orbital decay increasing burst frequency is a separate prediction not implied by the model. - D) Plasma cloud emitting visible light is not a prediction of the described mechanism.

KEY INSIGHT 💡 Orbital model → periodic passages through the cloud → periodic burst clusters.

FAST METHOD ✂ Orbiting → returns to the same spot → roughly periodic → burst clusters should be roughly periodic.

Q79. Correct Answer: B

REASONING: Story-only: \$28. Statistics-only: \$16. Combined: \$19 (lower than story-only). Adding statistics to an emotional story reduces donations. The practical implication for charities: don't combine emotional narratives with statistics.

WHY EACH WRONG:

- A) "Always less persuasive" is too absolute; the combined condition still outperformed statistics-only.
- C) Calling donors "irrational" is normative, not implied by Brandt's research.

- D) The victim in the study is described as a child, but the effect isn't limited to children. **TRAP ALERT** 🚫 A sounds like it follows from the data, but the combined condition (\$19) > statistics-only (\$16), so statistics aren't always less persuasive — they just interfere with emotional appeals.

KEY INSIGHT 🧠 Analytical mode suppresses emotional response → combining story + stats → lower donations than story alone.

FAST METHOD ⚡ Story alone > story + stats → don't combine them if you want max donations.

Q80. Correct Answer: B

REASONING: Trade was already rising before the treaty (due to railroads). Post-treaty acceleration was "only modestly greater" than the pre-treaty trend. This means infrastructure was the primary driver, and the tariff reduction added only incremental impetus.

WHY EACH WRONG: - A) "No measurable effect" contradicts "post-treaty acceleration, while real." - C) Kessler shows railroad expansion predated the treaty, so railroads weren't caused by it. - D) "Always less effective" overgeneralizes from one case.

KEY INSIGHT 🧠 Pre-existing trend + modest post-treaty acceleration → infrastructure was the fundamental driver; tariff reduction was incremental.

FAST METHOD ⚡ Rising before the treaty → treaty added a little more → infrastructure mattered more than tariffs.

TOPIC SUMMARY

Top 3 Mistakes Students Make on Inference / Complete-the-Text

1. **Choosing answers that go too far.** The most common trap is an option that makes a claim broader, more absolute, or more extreme than the passage supports. Words like "always," "never," "all," "solely," "proves," and "universally" are red flags. The correct answer almost always uses hedged language ("may," "suggests," "can," "some").
2. **Confusing "mentioned in the passage" with "supported by the passage."** Trap answers often contain ideas or vocabulary that appear in the passage but do not match the passage's logical flow. A detail can be mentioned without being the correct logical extension. Always trace the argument's reasoning chain before selecting.
3. **Selecting an answer that introduces outside knowledge.** The correct answer must follow from the passage's own logic, not from what you happen to know about the topic. A plausible real-world answer that isn't supported by the specific text is wrong.

Top 3 Rules for Inference / Complete-the-Text

1. **Follow the logical thread.** Identify the passage's main claim, the evidence or mechanism described, and the direction the argument is heading. The correct completion extends that direction — no more, no less.
2. **Match the passage's tone and scope.** If the passage is cautious ("suggests," "may"), the answer should be cautious. If the passage discusses one species, the answer shouldn't generalize to all species.
3. **Eliminate extremes, then choose the most directly supported option.** After removing answers with absolute language or unsupported claims, the remaining choice that most tightly connects to the passage's specific evidence is correct.

Expected Frequency per Module

Inference / Complete-the-Text questions typically appear **3-5 times per module** on the Digital SAT Reading & Writing section (both Module 1 and Module 2), making them one of the most frequently tested skills. Across both modules, expect **6-10 inference questions per test**. They appear at all difficulty levels, with the hardest versions often involving dual-text passages or multi-step reasoning chains.

END OF DOC 2 — SOLUTIONS